It goes to the credit of our men that they bore this imposition stoically, even cheerfully.

As the days became weeks, we realized that we had to do something to get the men back to their units, many of which were in hard field areas. We hit upon the idea of running special trains and convoys in a 'green bubble'. A convoy would start from a military garrison, a 'green' (safe) zone and then proceed non-stop to the next military garrison, another 'green' zone. Similarly, military special trains were requisitioned, which would be self-contained for food and water for the duration of the journey, halting only at bigger military cantonments. In this manner, we were able to start getting our boys back, while always adhering to the rules. At the destination end, all returning personnel were put into quarantine and only allowed to rejoin their units and the general military population thereafter. In addition, personnel proceeding to border outposts were made to go through two, or sometimes even three rounds of quarantine before reaching their forward posts, where the presence of even one infected person could have catastrophic consequences. This was all happening at the height of the Galwan crisis when units were deployed at the most inhospitable locations far from any medical aid. It goes to the credit of all the Commanders in the chain that they ensured that operational readiness was never compromised. There was not a single instance when any Section or Platoon was 'unfit' due to Covid casualties. We did have our fair share of Covid infections and even Covid-related deaths, the figures for which were put up to me Command-wise every morning as a Covid Sitrep. The figures were very revealing. While our overall cases were more than the national average, probably due to our enhanced testing, the number of deaths was much lower, most likely due to our early detection and better fitness levels. The Covid count in terms of percentage of the

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